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7ANALYTICS

BSCS-C303

Finals Essay Task 1. Assessment on your Understanding as to what really matters to become Data Analysts. And How to integrate SQL into your Data Analysis.

Following the video that you have watch and article that I ask you to read please answer the ff: question using your own words in 2–3 sentences based on the provided source material.

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?

- The main factors are strong fundamentals, real project experience, domain knowledge, and communication skills. Employers are no longer impressed by tools alone, they look for people who can solve real problems and clearly explain insights.

2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?

- Domain knowledge helps you understand the context behind the data, so your analysis becomes more relevant and actionable. A technical candidate may find patterns, but someone with domain expertise can explain why those patterns matter to the business.

3. What is the "lean tech stack" recommended for a foundational data analyst role?

- The lean stack focuses on SQL, spreadsheets like Excel, and a BI tool such as Tableau or Power BI. These tools cover most real-world tasks like querying data, analyzing it, and presenting insights without unnecessary complexity.

4. Distinguish between "learning projects" and "showing projects."

- Learning projects are simple exercises meant to practice skills and follow tutorials. Showing projects are more polished, original, and focused on solving real problems, making them suitable for portfolios and job applications.

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

- Python is often seen as optional because most analyst tasks are already handled by SQL and BI tools. Many roles prioritize business impact and data querying over programming, so Python becomes a secondary or “nice-to-have” skill rather than a core requirement.

—Questions on SQL-Base on the Article Posted—

6. Why is establishing the “Business Context” essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

- A business context refers to the goals, challenges, and overall situation of a company or project. It matters because it guides what data should be analyzed and keeps the results meaningful. Without it, an analysis might be correct in numbers but irrelevant in practice.

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a “flashlight”?

- SQL is compared to a flashlight because it helps analysts look into large datasets and find specific insights. It allows them to focus on important areas and uncover patterns with clarity. Instead of searching blindly, it gives direction and control during analysis.

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

- Validation is essential because it ensures that the data and conclusions are accurate and trustworthy. Skipping this step can lead to mistakes that affect decisions and outcomes. Checking the work helps maintain reliability and professional credibility.

9. What defines “good SQL” according to the author’s standards?

- Good SQL is code that is clean, efficient, and easy for others to read and understand. It should be organized, properly written, and optimized for performance. It is not just about getting the correct result but also making the code maintainable for a team.

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

- The key mindset shift is moving from simply completing tasks to solving real-world problems. Instead of focusing only on techniques, an analyst considers context, impact, and decision-making. The aim becomes creating value rather than just producing results.